Boeing's Biggest 737 Max Jet Gets Approved to Fly Passengers

From: NPR World Mined: 2026-10-21 3 min read

On Tuesday, the **Federal Aviation Administration**, or FAA, said Boeing's 737 Max 10 jet can carry passengers. The FAA is the U.S. **agency** that keeps air travel safe. Boeing first showed the plane in 2017, so the **approval** took nearly ten years.

Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy shared the news at Boeing's **factory** in Everett, Washington. He said the plane went through thousands of hours of test flights and safety checks.

The Max 10 is the biggest plane in its family. It can carry about 185 to 210 people. That could mean more seats on busy **routes**.

Boeing has had safety problems in the past, including two crashes of a smaller Max 8 plane in 2018 and 2019. Those led the FAA to check Boeing's planes more closely.

More than 30 customers have ordered 1,555 Max 10 jets. Boeing plans to start delivering them in 2027. Each jet must still be checked before it carries passengers.

Word Treasure

Federal Aviation Administration -- The U.S. government group that keeps air travel safe.
agency -- A government office that does a special job.
approval -- Official permission to do something.
factory -- A building where things are made.
routes -- The paths planes or buses travel between places.

Background you need

Before a new plane can carry people, the FAA checks that it is built to be safe.

Planes go through many test flights and reviews before they are approved.

Boeing is a big American company that builds airplanes.

Break it down

WHO: The FAA, Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy and Boeing
WHAT: The 737 Max 10 jet was approved to carry passengers
WHERE: Boeing's factory in Everett, Washington
WHY: The plane passed thousands of hours of test flights and safety checks

Why it matters

Bigger planes could mean more seats on busy routes when families travel.

Test what you remember

1. What plane did the FAA approve?

- (A) Boeing's 737 Max 10
- (B) A helicopter
- (C) A space rocket
- (D) A small toy plane

2. What does the FAA do?

- (A) Builds airplanes
- (B) Keeps air travel safe
- (C) Runs airports in Japan
- (D) Sells plane tickets

3. Where did Sean Duffy share the news?

- (A) At a school
- (B) In Paris
- (C) On a plane
- (D) At Boeing's factory in Everett, Washington

4. About how many people can the Max 10 carry?

- (A) 500
- (B) 10 to 20
- (C) 1,555
- (D) 185 to 210

5. When does Boeing plan to start delivering the planes?

- (A) 2019
- (B) 2024
- (C) 2027
- (D) 2017

6. What must happen before each jet carries passengers?

- (A) It must fly to Paris
- (B) It must be painted red
- (C) Nothing
- (D) It must be checked

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: B 3: D 4: D 5: C 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy: The plane went through thousands of hours of test flights and safety checks.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):